

RESEARCHER INTEGRATION GUIDE

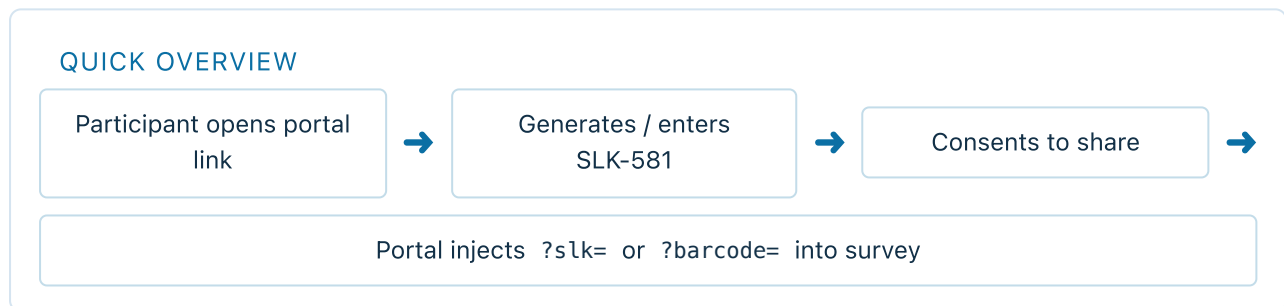
My Health Passport Portal – Survey Field Injection Protocol

Executive summary

The My Health Passport Portal provides a secure landing page where participants generate or enter their Statistical Linkage Key (SLK-581) before commencing a research study. After explicit consent, the portal injects either:

- **Standard SLK-581 key** – a pseudo-anonymous linkage identifier, or
- **SHA-256 encrypted barcode** – a one-way cryptographic hash of the SLK-581

This identifier is passed into your REDCap or Qualtrics survey via URL parameter injection, enabling robust participant linkage without collecting first or last names.



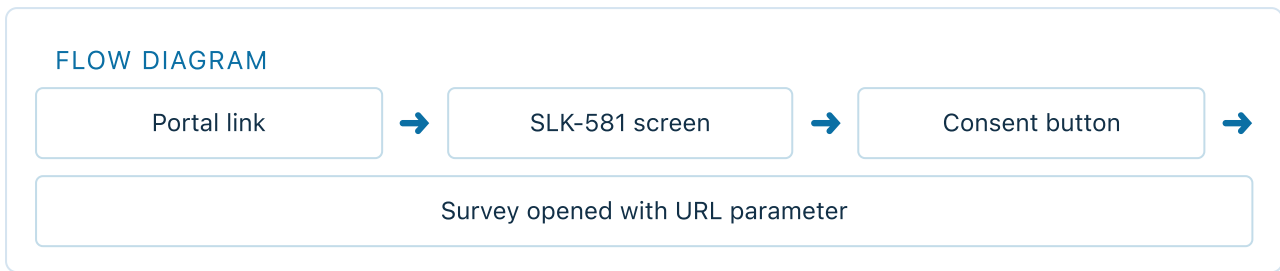
Quick start summary

1. **Build your survey** in REDCap or Qualtrics.
2. **Add a receiving field** named `slk` (SLK mode) or `barcode` (encrypted mode) on the first page/top of flow.
3. **Construct your portal link** using the GitHub-hosted portal and the correct query parameters.
4. **Test the link** end-to-end with a dummy participant before live deployment.

1. Portal workflow overview

1. **Participant landing** – The participant opens your customised My Health Passport Portal link.
2. **Identity key generation** – The participant enters or generates their SLK-581.
3. **Consent to share** – The participant clicks “Share your My Health Passport Number with [Your Study Title]”.

4. **Field injection & redirect** – The portal opens your survey in a new tab and injects either `?slk=` or `?barcode=` depending on the selected mode.



2. Constructing your bespoke portal link

All studies use the GitHub-hosted My Health Passport Portal as the official endpoint:

`https://martindutch76.github.io/My-Health-Passport/portal.html`

Your distribution link must include three query parameters:

```

https://martindutch76.github.io/My-Health-Passport/portal.html
?siteTitle=[YOUR_SURVEY_NAME]
&siteUrl=[YOUR_SURVEY_URL]
&barcode=[true|false]
  
```

Parameter definitions

- **siteTitle** – The title of your study (e.g., *Sky Colour Survey*). Spaces must be encoded as `%20`.
- **siteUrl** – The direct public link to your REDCap or Qualtrics survey.
- **barcode** – Selects the injection mode:
 - `barcode=false` → Standard SLK-581 mode (`?slk=` injected)
 - `barcode=true` → SHA-256 encrypted barcode mode (`?barcode=` injected)

Important: The `barcode` parameter is case-sensitive and must be lowercase (`true` / `false`). Only one mode is active per link.

Recommended usage

Standard SLK-581 mode

Use when your study requires a direct pseudo-anonymous linkage key.

- Portal injects `?slk=`

SHA-256 barcode mode

Use when your study prefers an additional cryptographic layer of protection.

- Survey field must be named slk

- Portal injects ?barcode=
- Survey field must be named barcode

3. Link examples

Example A – Standard SLK-581 mode

Title: Sky Colour Survey

Target survey: <https://biredcap.mh.org.au/surveys/?s=94W4TWNW3XL3EMTP>

Portal link:

```
https://martindutch76.github.io/My-Health-Passport/portal.html
?siteTitle=Sky%20Colour%20Survey
&siteUrl=https://biredcap.mh.org.au/surveys/?s=94W4TWNW3XL3EMTP
&barcode=false
```

Example B – SHA-256 barcode mode

Title: Sky Colour Survey

Target survey: <https://biredcap.mh.org.au/surveys/?s=94W4TWNW3XL3EMTP>

Portal link:

```
https://martindutch76.github.io/My-Health-Passport/portal.html
?siteTitle=Sky%20Colour%20Survey
&siteUrl=https://biredcap.mh.org.au/surveys/?s=94W4TWNW3XL3EMTP
&barcode=true
```

4. Survey platform setup

Critical requirement for multi-page surveys: The receiving field must be placed on the **first page** (REDCap) or at the **top of the Survey Flow** (Qualtrics). If placed later, the incoming URL parameter may be lost before capture.

Option A – REDCap setup

SLK-581 mode (barcode=false)

1. Open your project and go to the **Online Designer**.
2. On the first survey instrument/page, add a new **Text Box** field.

3. Set the **Field Name** to exactly `slk`.
4. Under **Action Tags / Field Annotation**, add `@READONLY` to prevent participant editing.

Barcode mode (`barcode=true`)

1. Open your project and go to the **Online Designer**.
2. On the first survey instrument/page, add a new **Text Box** field.
3. Set the **Field Name** to exactly `barcode`.
4. Under **Action Tags / Field Annotation**, add `@READONLY`.

Option B – Qualtrics setup

SLK-581 mode (`barcode=false`)

1. Open your survey and navigate to the **Survey Flow** tab.
2. Click **Add a New Element Here** and select **Embedded Data**.
3. Name the field exactly `slk` (leave value blank).
4. Drag the Embedded Data block to the very top of your Survey Flow (above Question Block 1).

Barcode mode (`barcode=true`)

1. Open your survey and navigate to the **Survey Flow** tab.
2. Click **Add a New Element Here** and select **Embedded Data**.
3. Name the field exactly `barcode` (leave value blank).
4. Drag the Embedded Data block to the very top of your Survey Flow (above Question Block 1).

5. SHA-256 encrypted barcode mode

When `barcode=true` is used, the portal transforms the participant's SLK-581 into a one-way SHA-256 cryptographic hash (the "My Health Passport Barcode") before it is transmitted to your survey.

- The hash is a fixed 64-character hexadecimal string.
- It is deterministic – the same SLK-581 always produces the same barcode.
- It cannot be reversed to recover the original SLK-581 or underlying demographics.

SECURITY MODEL

SLK-581 generated



SHA-256 hashed locally



Barcode injected into
survey (`?barcode=`)

When barcode mode is active, the portal's consent button and disclaimer text automatically update to reflect that an encrypted barcode – not the raw Passport Number – is being shared.

6. HREC ethics statement template

Researchers may adapt the following text for Human Research Ethics Committee (HREC) submissions:

"Data collection will utilise the My Health Passport Portal as a secure participant landing page. Participants will generate or provide their Statistical Linkage Key (SLK-581) on the portal. Upon explicit participant authorisation, either the pseudo-anonymised SLK-581 code or, where barcode mode is selected, a one-way SHA-256 cryptographic hash derived from it, will be transmitted into the research database via URL parameter injection. No identifying first or last names are captured or transmitted during this process."

7. Common errors & testing checklist

Common configuration errors

- **Incorrect field name** – using `slk_code` or `barcode_id` instead of `slk` or `barcode` .
- **Field placed on page 2+** – URL parameter lost during navigation.
- **Missing URL encoding** – spaces in `siteTitle` not encoded as `%20` .
- **Wrong barcode parameter** – using `barcode=True` instead of lowercase `true` .
- **Survey Flow order** – Embedded Data block not at the top in Qualtrics.

Testing checklist

1. Open the portal link in a browser and confirm the study title displays correctly.
2. Generate a test SLK-581 and proceed through the consent screen.
3. Verify that the survey opens and that the correct field (`slk` or `barcode`) is populated.
4. Confirm that the field is read-only to participants.
5. Repeat tests for both `barcode=false` and `barcode=true` if your study uses both modes.

8. Frequently asked questions

Does the portal store SLK-581 values?

The portal is designed to inject the SLK-581 or its SHA-256 barcode into your survey via URL parameters. Storage behaviour should be documented in your system architecture and ethics submission; the intent of this guide is that only the research database retains identifiers.

Can participants skip the portal?

If participants bypass the portal and access the survey directly, the SLK-581 or barcode will not be injected. Your recruitment materials should emphasise using the portal link or QR code.

Does barcode mode allow re-identification?

The SHA-256 barcode is a one-way hash of the SLK-581. It cannot be reversed to recover the original key or demographic details, but it can be used consistently as a linkage identifier.

9. Branding & accessibility notes

- **QR codes** – Use the full portal link when generating QR codes for posters and flyers.
- **Colour contrast** – Maintain sufficient contrast between text and background for readability.
- **Mobile-friendly layout** – Ensure the portal and survey render correctly on smartphones and tablets.
- **Plain-language explanations** – Provide a short description of SLK-581 and barcode mode in participant-facing materials.

Your health research identity. Your choice.

My Health Passport Portal – GitHub deployment: <https://martindutch76.github.io/My-Health-Passport/portal.html>